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News Release News Release

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TANDY INTRODUCES LIGHTWEIGHT, COMPATIBLE LAPTOP PORTABLE COMPUTER

Fort Worth, TX -- John V. Roach, chairman and chief executive officer of Tandy Corporation, introduced today the new, ultra-light Tandy® 1100 FD laptop portable computer, to leading industry analysts meeting in Fort Worth.

The 1100 FD with DOS and DeskMate® built-in may be the industry's first "ideal solution" for portable computer users who need PC compatibility but do not want the trade-off of a heavier weight, higher cost, larger size and shorter battery life.

Weighing less than 6.5 pounds, the 1100 FD is one of the lightest PC-compatible computers on the market. It is the first portable computer to build in the ease-of-use and friendly look and feel of the DeskMate graphical user interface.

The 1100 FD's unique design features the MS-DOS® 3.3 operating system, the DeskMate Desktop, DeskMate's TEXT application and DeskMate's 90,000-word spell checker in ROM (Read-Only Memory). With these features, one industry-standard 3.5-inch 720K (Kilobyte) disk drive gives the 1100 FD more functionality than any other portable with the same drive -- or even desktop systems with dual 360K drives.

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The 1100 FD operates on a removeable, rechargeable and inexpensive battery for more than five hours -- longer than most PC-compatible battery-operated portables. An AC adapter/recharger is included.

The 1100 FD has an 80 x 25, high-contrast liquid crystal display with 640 x 200 resolution. The fold-over display measures approximately nine inches diagonally and closely resembles the aspect ratio of conventional video monitors.

Other features of the 1100 FD include a NEC® V-20 microprocessor with a clock speed of 8MHz (megahertz), 640K of available memory, a full-size 84-key keyboard with enhanced keypad emulation, low-battery indicator, battery-saving standby mode, built-in real time clock, parallel printer port, serial communications port and one dedicated internal modem slot.

In addition to its built-in ROM features, the standard array of DeskMate applications, accessories and utilities -- Worksheet, Filer, Telecom, Calendar, Address Book, PC-Link™ and more -- are included on floppy disks with the 1100 FD.

The 1100 FD's "clamshell" design has a small footprint of 12.1 x 2.4 x 9.8 inches.

Options for the 1100 FD laptop portable are a 2400 bps (bits per second) internal modem (catalog #25-3538) for \$199.95; a replacement battery (catalog #25-3536) for \$29.95; and, a choice of durable carrying cases.

Retail priced at \$999, the Tandy 1100 FD portable laptop computer (catalog #25-3530) is expected to be available by December. Prices are good at more than 7,000 Radio Shack Computer Centers®, Radio Shack® stores and participating dealers nationwide.

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